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BANGALORE

A Project Report

On

# "Pediatric Tele dermatology"

Batch Details

| Sl. No. | Roll Number | Student Name |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | 20211CSE0823 | MD Haseebuddin |
| 2 | 20211CSE0808 | Shaik Ahmed |
| 3 | 20211CSE0559 | Mohammed Noaman Ahmed |

**School of Computer Science,**

**Presidency University, Bengaluru.**

Under the guidance of,

Ms. Akkamahadevi

School of Computer Science,

Presidency University, Bengaluru

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# 1. INTRODUCTION

The diagnosis of neonatal and pediatric skin conditions presents unique challenges, as the patients are highly sensitive and often unable to articulate their symptoms. Skin issues in infants and young children, such as eczema, rashes, birthmarks, or infections, typically exhibit distinct visual characteristics that can be assessed remotely. Given the availability of smartphones and internet access, telemedicine has become a promising solution in this domain.

Remote dermatological consultations, particularly for pediatric and neonatal cases, leverage image-based assessments. These allow healthcare providers to diagnose and recommend treatment plans without the need for in-person visits. This is particularly valuable in regions with limited access to specialized care or during situations where face-to-face consultations may not be feasible. By enabling parents or caregivers to capture images of the child's skin condition and send them to physicians, healthcare services can be provided quickly and efficiently.

An application that facilitates the remote exchange of medical images, diagnosis tagging, and response management offers significant advantages for both physicians and patients. Furthermore, incorporating the ability to store images for research purposes could contribute to advances in pediatric dermatology by providing valuable data for future studies. In this context, the focus is not on automating diagnosis but on streamlining the communication process between patients and healthcare providers for more efficient and effective care.

An app designed to facilitate the remote diagnosis of neonatal and pediatric skin conditions could address several key needs in this domain:

1. **Image Submission**: Caregivers can capture images of the child's skin condition using their smartphone and send these images directly to a healthcare provider within the app. This removes the barrier of distance and provides physicians with high-quality visual data.
2. **Diagnosis Tagging**: Once the physician receives the image, they can review it and tag the diagnosis based on their assessment. This feature enables clear and consistent documentation of the condition, ensuring the right diagnosis is communicated back to the caregiver.
3. **Data Storage for Research**: The app would also include functionality to automatically store images and corresponding diagnosis information for research purposes. This would create a valuable database of pediatric dermatological cases that could aid in future research, improve diagnostic accuracy, and potentially contribute to the development of new treatments.
4. **Physician Response**: After reviewing the image and making a diagnosis, the

physician can provide a response to the caregiver directly within the app, offering advice on treatment or next steps. This streamlined communication helps ensure that caregivers receive timely advice, reducing the need for unnecessary appointments or hospital visits.

# 2. LITERATURE REVIEW

Importance of Remote Dermatological Assessment

Remote dermatological assessment of pediatric and neonatal patients is critical due to the accessibility and convenience it provides to both patients and healthcare providers. Studies indicate that remote diagnosis for skin-related conditions has a high accuracy rate, especially when combined with brief clinical histories. It minimizes unnecessary in-person visits, reducing the burden on healthcare systems and alleviating patient discomfort.

For neonatal and pediatric patients, early detection and intervention for skin conditions are crucial, as untreated conditions may lead to long-term complications. A mobile app system that allows healthcare providers to receive images, tag diagnoses, store them for research, and respond to parents is a valuable solution, particularly for parents who may lack immediate access to pediatric dermatologists.

## Existing Solutions and Their Limitations

1. **Dermatology-Specific Telemedicine Platforms**

   Platforms like *DermEngine* and *Dermatology AI* have integrated mobile-based image sharing and diagnostics into their telemedicine frameworks. These systems enable dermatologists to receive images, perform assessments, and provide treatment recommendations. However, they are often general-purpose dermatology tools that lack a focus on neonatal and pediatric patients. The image quality, parental compliance with capturing accurate images, and the lack of specific pediatric diagnosis options in these platforms remain limitations.

   **Disadvantages**:

   - General dermatological platforms may not account for the unique diagnostic requirements of pediatric patients.
   - Lack of structured tagging and automatic image storage for research purposes, which is critical for academic and clinical advancements in neonatal dermatology.
   - Concerns over image quality, as parents may not take pictures with proper lighting or angles, resulting in incorrect diagnosis.

2. **AI-Based Dermatology Apps**

   Some platforms, like *SkinVision* or *Miiskin*, use AI to assist in diagnosing skin conditions through images. While these apps demonstrate promise in remote assessment, the reliance on automated diagnosis is a disadvantage in pediatric care, where specialized human insight is essential. Furthermore, AI models often underperform when faced with pediatric skin conditions, as the training data used in these models typically skew towards adult dermatology cases. **Disadvantages**:

- The automated diagnosis feature may not be reliable for rare or complex neonatal conditions.
- AI-based platforms often overlook the need for image tagging and systematic storage for research purposes.

3. **Telemedicine Platforms in Pediatric Care**

Platforms like *PediaDerm* have been designed for pediatric dermatology but are not widespread. These platforms allow pediatricians and dermatologists to remotely assess patients using images. However, the systems often do not integrate research-oriented features, such as automatic image tagging and storage. This limits the potential to build large datasets for studying trends and improving treatment strategies in pediatric populations. **Disadvantages**:

- Lack of integration with research platforms to build and store a dataset for longitudinal studies.
- No built-in tagging features to help with future automated pattern recognition.

Research Gaps and Opportunities

Despite the availability of telemedicine platforms, a dedicated mobile application system designed specifically for pediatric and neonatal dermatology, which focuses on both clinical and research purposes, remains underdeveloped. The integration of features that allow physicians to tag diagnoses, automatically store images for research, and offer a quick response to caregivers could provide a substantial benefit. Additionally, focusing on optimizing the image quality captured by parents or caregivers can lead to more accurate diagnoses and improve the dataset's reliability for research.

Moreover, privacy and security concerns must be addressed, particularly in pediatric healthcare, where patient confidentiality is paramount. Research is needed on effective encryption and secure storage methods for sensitive patient images.

# 3. OBJECTIVES

**1. Develop an Image-Based Diagnosis Platform**
Create a mobile application that allows physicians to remotely receive and review high-quality images of neonatal and pediatric skin conditions submitted by caregivers for diagnosis.

**2. Enable Physician-Tagged Diagnosis**
Implement a system within the app that allows physicians to tag images with a diagnosis and related medical notes, ensuring accuracy and facilitating structured data collection for research purposes.

**3. Automate Image Storage for Research**
Build an automated storage feature that securely saves all submitted and diagnosed images, along with relevant metadata (e.g., diagnosis, patient age, region), for future research and academic use in the field of pediatric dermatology.

**4. Provide Secure Communication for Feedback**
Ensure the app allows physicians to securely respond to caregivers with a diagnosis and recommendations, while safeguarding patient privacy through encryption and secure data management practices.

**5. Enhance Usability for Caregivers**
Develop user-friendly features to guide caregivers on how to capture high-quality images, ensuring optimal lighting and angle for accurate diagnosis by physicians.

**6. Ensure Regulatory Compliance and Data Privacy**
Adhere to healthcare regulations (such as HIPAA or GDPR) to maintain patient confidentiality and ensure secure handling and storage of sensitive medical information.

# 4. EXPERIMENTAL DETAILS

1. Hardware Requirements

- **Smartphones/Tablets**
  Caregivers will need smartphones or tablets with a functioning camera to capture images of the skin conditions and submit them to the platform. The minimum requirements include:
  - **Camera**: At least 8 MP (megapixels) to ensure image clarity for diagnosis.
  - **Processor**: Quad-core 1.5 GHz or higher for smooth app performance.
  - **RAM**: 2 GB or higher.
  - **Storage**: Minimum of 500 MB available for app installation and temporary image storage.
  - Operating Systems:
    - Android 8.0 (Oreo) or higher.
    - iOS 12.0 or higher.
- **Server/CloudInfrastructure**
  A server or cloud service will be required to store images, process data, and manage secure communication between physicians and caregivers. Requirements include:
  - **Storage**: Scalable cloud storage (Azure) to handle a large volume of images.
  - **Processor**: Multi-core processors with at least 16 GB RAM for handling multiple requests.
  - **Security**: Encryption hardware for securing sensitive data.
- **Physician's_Device**
  Physicians will need access to:
  - **Desktop/Laptop/Tablet**: Devices that can access the app dashboard.
  - **Screen Resolution**: At least 1280x720 pixels for clear viewing of images.
  - **Internet Connectivity**: Stable, high-speed internet connection to download and review large image files.

2. Software Requirements

- **Mobile App Development Framework** The app will be developed for both Android and iOS platforms using a cross-platform framework:
  - **React Native**: Suitable for developing high-performance mobile apps with a single codebase for both Android and iOS.
- **Backend Development** :A robust backend is required to handle image uploads, tagging, storage, and communication with the caregivers:
  - **Node.js**: For creating a secure and scalable backend that supports API communication with the mobile app.
  - **RESTful API**: For facilitating communication between the front end

(mobile app) and the backend.
  - **Firestore**: Can be used for real-time database functionalities, image upload, and notifications.

- **Database**
  To store user data, diagnosis records, and other relevant metadata:
  - **MySQL**: For structured data storage (e.g., diagnosis tags, user information).

- Notifications and Communication
  - **Firebase Cloud Messaging** (FCM) for Android to notify caregivers of updates from physicians.

- **Version Control**: Git (GitHub or GitLab) for tracking code changes and collaboration.

# 5. METHODOLOGY

1. Requirements Gathering

In this phase, the functional and non-functional requirements of the system are gathered. Stakeholders, including physicians and caregivers, provide input on essential features for the diagnosis app. This phase involves:

- Understanding the user's needs for submitting images and receiving diagnoses.
- Determining the features physicians require for tagging and storing images for research purposes.

2. System Design

The system design phase focuses on the architecture of the app, including both frontend and backend components. It includes designing the user interface (UI) and user experience (UX) of the app, as well as the underlying backend infrastructure for handling data.

2.1 Architecture Design

The architecture will be divided into three layers:

- **Presentation Layer**: User-facing mobile app (for caregivers and physicians).
- **Logic Layer**: Backend server handling image uploads, diagnosis tagging, and communication between the caregiver and physician.
- **Data Layer**: Secure cloud-based storage for images, diagnosis information, and research data.

2.2 Database Design

A relational database will be used for structured data like user profiles, diagnosis records, and image metadata. Data will be securely encrypted and stored in compliance with privacy laws.

2.3 User Interface Design

The UI design will focus on two interfaces:

1. **Caregiver Mobile App**: A user-friendly interface that guides caregivers through image submission with clear instructions for capturing images.
2. **Physician Interface**: A mobile application interface that allows physicians to view, tag, and respond to image submissions, with easy access to previous cases for research purposes.

3. App Development

This phase involves developing both the frontend and backend components based on the system design.

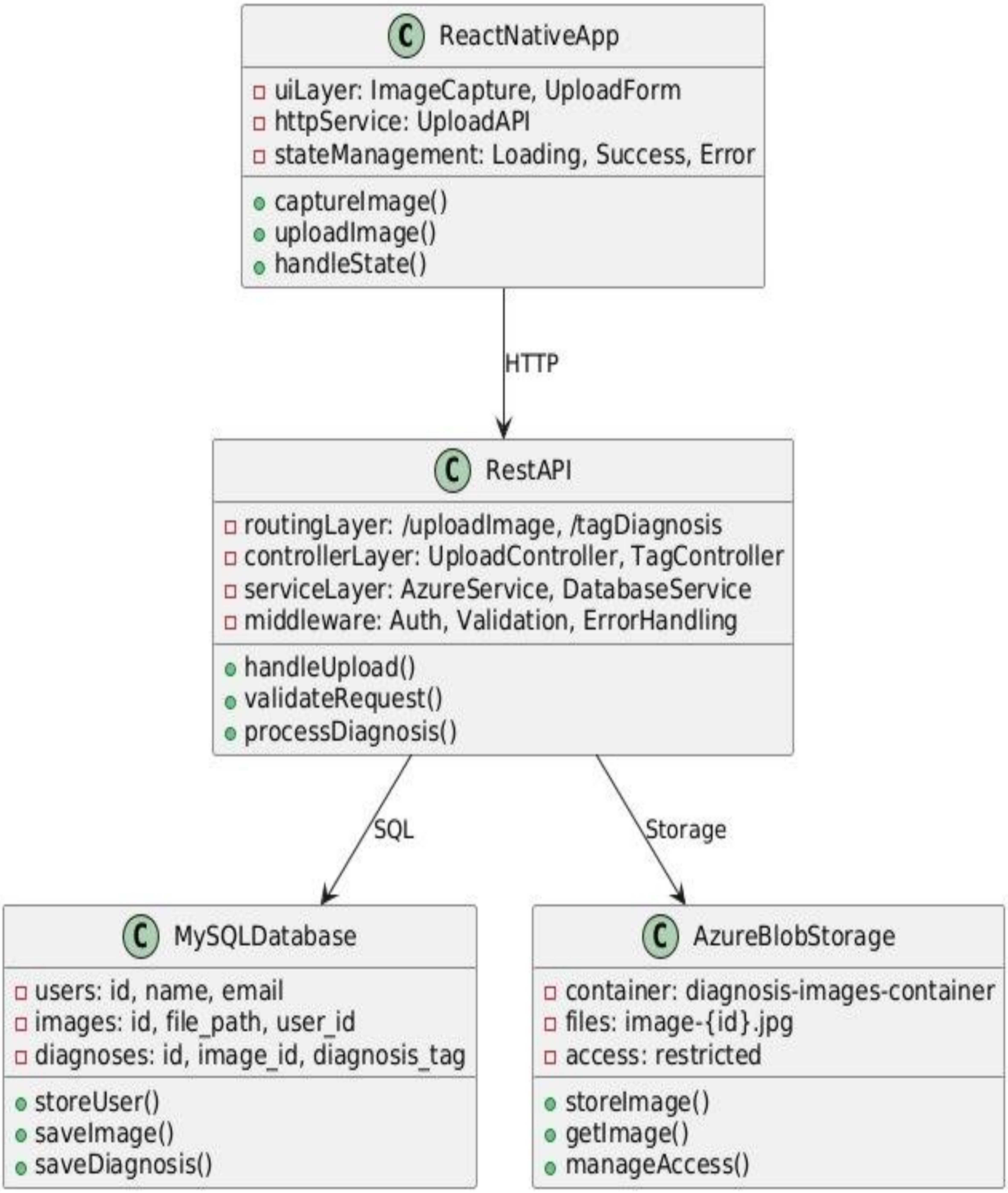
3.1 Frontend Development

- **Caregiver Mobile App** (using React Native): The app will be developed to allow caregivers to submit images and receive feedback.
- **Physician Dashboard** (using React Native): Physicians can log into to view images, tag diagnoses, and store records for research.

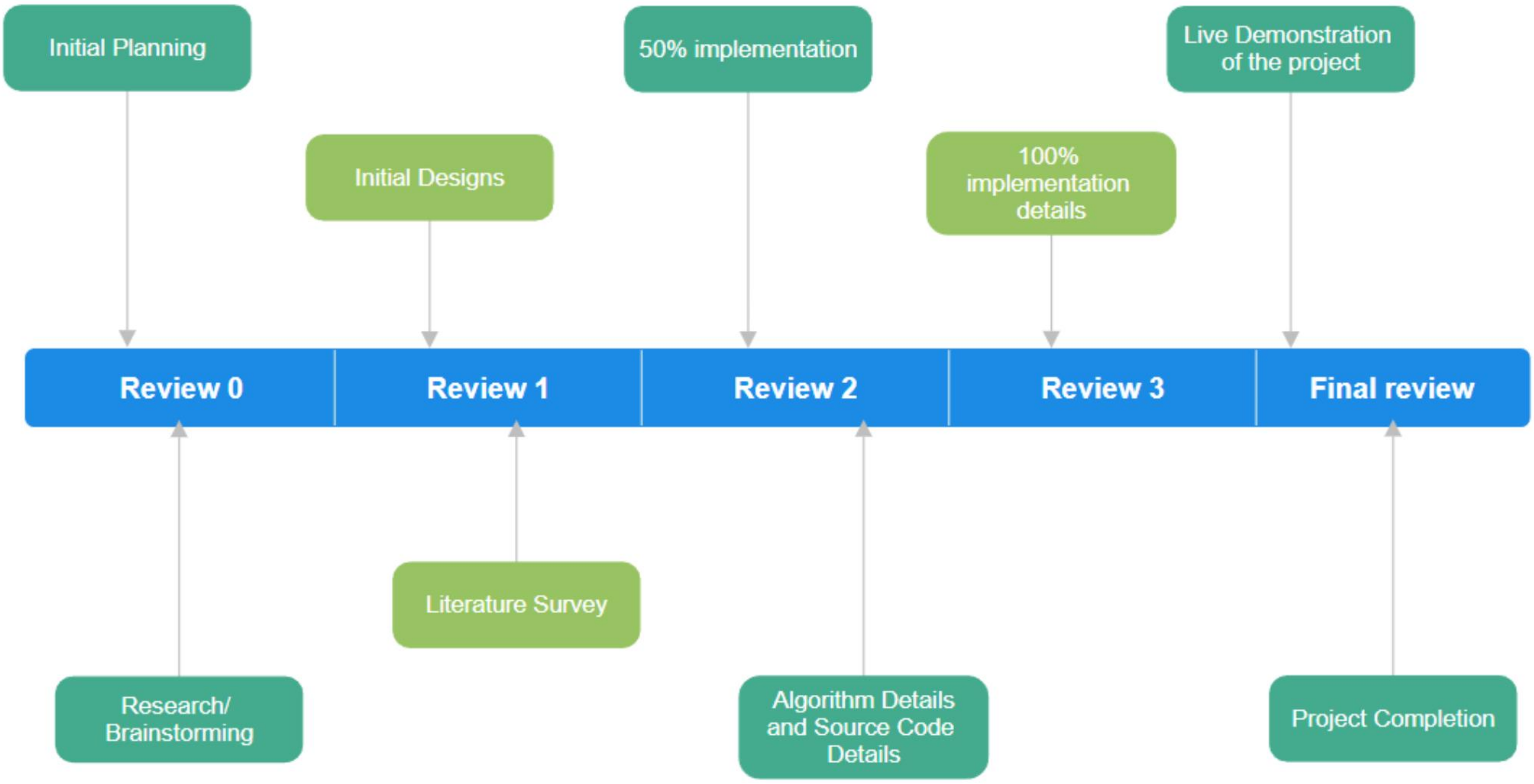
- 3.2 Backend Development
- **API Development**: RESTful APIs will be developed using Node.js to enable secure communication between the mobile app and the database.
- **Cloud Integration**: The app will be integrated with a cloud service (Azure) to store and manage large image datasets securely.
- **Security Implementation**: The app will incorporate secure data transfer protocols (SSL), user authentication (JWT), and encryption for image and diagnosis data.

This structured methodology ensures the system is developed to meet the requirements of caregivers and physicians while maintaining high security, usability, and scalability.

# 6. ARCHITECTURE



# 7. TIMELINE OF THE PROJECT



# 8. CONCLUSION

The Remote Pediatric and Neonatal Skin Diagnosis App addresses a crucial healthcare need by enabling remote diagnosis of skin conditions in infants and children. Through the use of mobile technology and cloud-based infrastructure, this project facilitates efficient and secure communication between caregivers and physicians, allowing timely diagnosis and treatment recommendations. The system's automated image storage for research purposes also contributes to the advancement of medical knowledge in pediatric dermatology.

By leveraging user-friendly mobile and web interfaces, a robust backend system, and secure data storage practices, the app simplifies the diagnostic process, ensuring accessibility to medical expertise regardless of geographical constraints. Furthermore, the project adheres to privacy regulations, ensuring data security and patient confidentiality. This app has the potential to enhance healthcare delivery, reduce travel costs, and contribute to improved health outcomes in neonatal and pediatric care.

With further development and deployment, the app can be refined to include more advanced features, such as enhanced image processing and predictive analytics, making it a valuable tool for both healthcare providers and researchers.

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